Prepflow

DAILY EDITION · FOR TONY DIBBIN

Wednesday, 4 November 2026.

Your daily radio show prep — three top news stories, forward-looking showbiz, sport that matters this week, talkback prompts, and day notes for today and tomorrow. Built fresh every weekday, ready by 3pm for tomorrow's show.

00 — WEATHER

Tomorrow's forecast

LONDON	BIRMINGHAM	MANCHESTER	GLASGOW
Overcast	Overcast	Overcast	Overcast
11° 8°	11° 7°	12° 9°	11° 6°

01 — NEWS

Today's top stories

1 **The jury in the Russell Brand rape trial has begun considering its verdicts after a three-week hearing.**
The media personality has been on trial for three weeks, having pleaded not guilty to all charges. The jury will now decide the outcome of the high-profile case.
CRIME · UK

2 **Andrew Mountbatten-Windsor has been called to give evidence in a High Court fraud trial next month.**
He has been summonsed to appear in December as part of a businessman's fraud trial. This development brings a royal figure into a significant legal case.
ROYAL · UK

3 **The Home Secretary has refused to put a cost on the government's climbdown over care worker settlement plans.**
Mahmood says the full financial implications of dropping plans to extend the wait for settlement will be revealed in the future. The decision follows a period of uncertainty for care workers.
POLITICS · UK

4 **Police are reportedly questioning convicted killer Steve Wright about a number of unsolved cold cases.**
The 68-year-old is being questioned following his sentencing earlier this year. Detectives are looking into potential links to other historical cases.
CRIME · UK

5 **The family of a teenage girl murdered by her ex-partner has been given hope for a change in the law.**
Holly Newton, aged 15, was tragically stabbed to death. Her family's campaign for legal reform appears to be making progress.
LAW · UK

02 — SHOWBIZ

What's coming up

1 **Bollywood star Ranbir Kapoor is set to lead a major new adaptation of the Indian epic Ramayana.**

The actor discussed his role, as well as the impact of AI and fatherhood on his life. This promises to be a huge cinematic event for fans of Indian cinema.

ON AIR — Are you excited to see a new take on such a classic story?

FILM · COMING SOON

2 **Pop star James Blunt has revealed he tried, and failed, to get banished from the hit show The Traitors.**

He's been opening up about his experience on the popular series and what really happened during James Acaster's banishment. Blunt also teased details about his new music.

ON AIR — Who would you love to see on the next series of Celebrity Traitors?

TV · COMING SOON

3 **A suitcase belonging to Elizabeth Taylor is going up for auction after being sent to Richard Burton's sister.**

The Welsh film star sent his then-wife's unwanted clothes to his sister. It's a fascinating piece of Hollywood history.

ON AIR — What's the most unusual celebrity item you've ever heard of going up for auction?

MEMORABILIA · FUTURE

4 **Halloween saw celebrities pulling out all the stops with some incredible and imaginative costumes.**

From Heidi Klum as a giant severed hand to Maya Jama as Sir Mo Farah, the stars embraced the spooky season. It was a fantastic display of creativity.

ON AIR — What was your favourite celebrity Halloween costume this year?

CELEBRITY · RECAP

5 **A new feature explores how one city became the vibrant home of drum and bass and jungle music.**

Artists inspired by sound systems, acid house, and hip hop changed the course of dance music forever. It's a look back at a pivotal moment in music history.

ON AIR — Which city do you think has had the biggest impact on UK music?

MUSIC · HISTORY

03 — SPORT

On the schedule

1 **England scrum-half Alex Mitchell has been ruled out of the entire Nations Championship due to injury.**
Mitchell has suffered his fourth hamstring injury of the year, a significant blow for the England squad. It's a tough break for the player and the team.
ON AIR — How big a loss do you think Mitchell will be for England in the Nations Championship?
RUGBY · UK

2 **Novak Djokovic is keeping his hopes alive to qualify for this year's ATP Finals after a win in Paris.**
He ground out a first-round victory at the Paris Masters, battling to secure his spot. It's a crucial push for the tennis legend.
ON AIR — Do you think Djokovic will make it to the ATP Finals this year?
TENNIS · INTERNATIONAL

3 **England's Wheelchair Rugby League team has powered into the World Cup semi-finals with a huge win over the USA.**
They beat the USA 134-0, with player Mason Billington rating their performance as a 'seven out of ten'. It's a dominant display from the squad.
ON AIR — How far do you think England can go in the Wheelchair Rugby League World Cup?
RUGBY · UK

4 **The 'fully loaded' All Blacks are determined to preserve their undefeated record against Scotland.**
Mike Blair says New Zealand are highly motivated as they head into their Murrayfield meeting. It promises to be a thrilling encounter.
ON AIR — Do you think Scotland can finally break their duck against the All Blacks at Murrayfield?
RUGBY · UK

5 **Crystal Palace are appealing against Jean-Philippe Mateta's red card from their recent defeat to Tottenham.**
The club is hoping to overturn the decision made during Saturday's match. It's a key moment for Mateta and the team.
ON AIR — Do you think Crystal Palace have a strong case to overturn Mateta's red card?
FOOTBALL · UK

04 — NEWSBRIEF

Quick hits

1 **The surprising charm of 'leaf peeping' is making a grand return to British parks and woodlands.**
Forget distant travel; new reports show more people are actively seeking out vibrant autumnal colours closer to home, finding simple joy in nature's annual spectacle.

2 **There's a quiet revolution happening in our kitchens: the art of 'repurposing food scraps'.**
It's not just about reducing waste; home cooks are discovering creative ways to turn humble peelings and offcuts into delicious broths and vibrant garnishes.

3 **A new appreciation for the 'distinctive chime of an old clock tower' is becoming a gentle urban trend.**
In our fast-paced world, many are finding a moment of calm and connection to history by pausing to listen to these timeless mechanical melodies.

4 **The simple pleasure of 'arranging items on a bookshelf by colour' is bringing unexpected calm to many homes.**
It's a subtle way to create visual harmony and a sense of order, turning a functional space into a mini art installation.

5 **Scientists are noting an intriguing rise in 'pet-sitting meetups' for local animal lovers.**
It's proving to be a fantastic way for neighbours to help each other out with furry friends, fostering community spirit and new friendships.

6 **The satisfying 'thud of a well-thrown newspaper through the letterbox' is being celebrated as a small, daily comfort.**
In a digital age, this tangible sign of the morning routine brings a reassuring connection to the outside world, even if it's just the headlines.

7 **A curious new study reveals the unexpected joy many find in 'straightening a wonky picture frame'.**
It seems the simple act of correcting a small imperfection brings a surprising sense of accomplishment and visual peace to our day.

05 — TALKBACK

For the phone lines

OUR SURVEY SAID

Q **Our survey said that over 60% of us admit to discreetly 'doing' what when we're trying to figure out if a new plant in a shop is healthy, even if we know it's not strictly scientific? What is it?**

ANSWER: GENTLY WOBBLING IT TO SEE IF IT FEELS STURDY IN ITS POT!

Q **Our survey said that over 70% of us admit to having a particular 'odd routine' they absolutely have to do before settling down to enjoy a lovely, new jar of jam, especially if it's a fancy, artisan one. What is it?**

ANSWER: MAKING SURE THE LABEL IS PERFECTLY ALIGNED AND FACING FORWARDS BEFORE OPENING IT!

TALK TOPIC

- **You know how sometimes a particular 'everyday texture' just brings you immense satisfaction or comfort?**
  Whether it's the smooth feel of a polished pebble, the soft warmth of a favourite jumper, or the satisfying roughness of a brick wall, what everyday texture just feels 'right' to you, and why?

- **We all have that 'one particular mug or cup' that just makes our morning brew taste better, don't we?**
  Is there a specific mug or cup in your cupboard that's your absolute go-to for tea or coffee, and what makes it so special? Is it the size, the handle, a memory, or just a feeling?

TRUE STORY OR JACKANORY — LISTENERS GUESS

FACT **Animals.** Octopuses have three hearts: two pump blood through the gills, while the third circulates it to the rest of the body.

FICTION **Made up, but believable.** The collective noun for a group of pandas is a 'bamboo grove'.

06 — LOTTERY

Jackpots ahead

NEXT EUROMILLIONS JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Tuesday or Friday · estimated

NEXT NATIONAL LOTTERY JACKPOT

£2.8 million

Next Wednesday or Saturday · estimated

07 — FACTS OF THE DAY

Did you know?

- The Great Fire of London in 1666 actually helped to eradicate the bubonic plague by destroying the rats and fleas that carried the disease.
- A jiffy is an actual unit of time: 1/100th of a second.
- There are more possible iterations of a game of chess than there are atoms in the observable universe.
- Honey never spoils; archaeologists have found pots of honey in ancient Egyptian tombs that are still edible.
- The electric chair was invented by a dentist.
- Strawberries are the only fruit that wear their seeds on the outside.
- The 'king' of a deck of playing cards is the only king without a moustache.
- Australia is wider than the Moon.

08 — TODAY'S DAY NOTES WED 4 NOV 2026

On this day

Day 308 of the year, 57 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: Charles Borromeo (Roman Catholic Church); Christian feast day: Emeric of Hungary; Christian feast day: Felix of Valois; Christian feast day: Blessed Françoise d'Amboise. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TODAY'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1918 — Art Carney, American actor (died 2003)
- 1970 — Tony Sly, American singer-songwriter and guitarist (died 2012)
- 1915 — Marguerite Patten, English economist and author (died 2015)
- 1956 — James Honeyman-Scott, English guitarist and songwriter (died 1982)
- 1919 — Martin Balsam, American actor, director, and screenwriter (died 1996)
- 1925 — Doris Roberts, American actress (died 2016)
- 1963 — Lena Zavaroni, Scottish singer and television host (died 1999)
- 1980 — Emme Rylan, American actress

THE DAY TODAY

- 1942 — World War II: Disobeying a direct order by Adolf Hitler, General Field Marshal Erwin Rommel begins a retreat of his forces after a costly defeat during the Second Battle of El Alamein. The retreat would ultimately last five months.
- 1956 — Soviet troops enter Hungary to end the Hungarian revolution against the Soviet Union that started on October 23. Thousands are killed, more are wounded, and nearly a quarter million leave the country.
- 1970 — Vietnam War: The United States turns over control of the air base at Bình Thủy in the Mekong Delta to South Vietnam.

TODAY IN MUSIC

- 1993 — China Airlines Flight 605, a brand-new 747-400, overruns the runway at Hong Kong Kai Tak Airport.
- 1962 — The United States concludes Operation Fishbowl, its final above-ground nuclear weapons testing series, in anticipation of the 1963 Partial Nuclear Test Ban Treaty.

TODAY IN HISTORY

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- 1942 — World War II: Disobeying a direct order by Adolf Hitler, General Field Marshal Erwin Rommel begins a retreat of his forces after a costly defeat during the Second Battle of El Alamein. The retreat would ultimately last five months.
- 2022 — The Khash massacre, which refers to the repression of protesters by Iranian security forces, resulting in 18 deaths and more than 20 injuries.

09 — TOMORROW'S DAY NOTES THU 5 NOV 2026

A peek at tomorrow

Day 309 of the year, 56 days left in 2026. Today Christian feast day: All Jesuit Saints and Blesseds; Christian feast day: Saint Domninus of Grenoble; Christian feast day: Blessed Bernhard Lichtenberg; Christian feast day: Berthild of Chelles. Star sign Scorpio, birthstone Topaz.

TOMORROW'S BIRTHDAYS

- 1975 — Lisa Scott-Lee, Welsh singer-songwriter
- 1971 — Jonny Greenwood, English guitarist and songwriter
- 1969 — Pat Kilbane, American actor, comedian, director and screenwriter
- 1937 — Harris Yulin, American actor (died 2025)
- 1974 — Ryan Adams, American singer-songwriter and guitarist
- 1949 — Jimmie Spheeris, American singer-songwriter (died 1984)
- 1958 — Don Falcone, American keyboard player, songwriter and producer
- 1958 — Mo Gaffney, American actress and screenwriter

THE DAY TOMORROW

- 1990 — Rabbi Meir Kahane, founder of the far-right Kach movement, is shot dead after a speech at a New York City hotel.
- 2015 — Rona Ambrose takes over after Stephen Harper as the Leader of the Conservative Party of Canada.
- 1995 — André Dallaire attempts to assassinate Prime Minister Jean Chrétien of Canada. He is thwarted when the Prime Minister's wife locks the door.

TOMORROW IN MUSIC

- 2006 — Saddam Hussein, the former president of Iraq, and his co-defendants Barzan Ibrahim al-Tikriti and Awad Hamed al-Bandar, are sentenced to death in the al-Dujail trial for their roles in the 1982 massacre of 148 Shia Muslims.
- 1970 — The Military Assistance Command, Vietnam reports the lowest weekly American soldier death toll in five years (24).

10 — FORWARD PLANNING · FILM

Coming to cinemas

11 — FORWARD PLANNING · SPORT

On the sporting calendar

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